

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Pagdalu Rajat Naidu

Address: 2 Newbolt Avenue North Cheam SM3 8EE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to this application on the grounds of highway safety and traffic impact.

1. Traffic Congestion and Road Safety

The proposed change of use to a Place of Worship and Community Hub is likely to generate a substantial increase in vehicle movements, particularly during peak service and event times. Dorset Road and the surrounding residential streets already experience congestion during busy periods. The development is therefore likely to result in:

Longer queues and hazardous turning manoeuvres

Illegal or inconsiderate parking

Restricted access for emergency vehicles

No comprehensive Transport Assessment has been provided to demonstrate that the existing road network can safely accommodate this additional traffic.

2. Proximity to Avenue Primary School - Risk to Children

Avenue Primary School is situated within approximately 1km of the site and relies on the same local access routes. Service and event peak times are likely to coincide with school drop-off and pick-up periods.

This overlap creates foreseeable safety concerns, including:

Increased conflict between higher volumes of vehicles and child pedestrians

Unsafe drop-off and pick-up practices

Greater risks for children crossing roads

The application fails to adequately address the protection of vulnerable road users.

3. Insufficient Parking and Traffic Management Measures

There is a lack of detail regarding:

Provision of dedicated parking spaces

Managed drop-off and pick-up arrangements

A clear event traffic management plan

Controlled dispersal procedures after services or events

In the absence of firm and enforceable mitigation measures, the proposal would lead to unacceptable impacts on both highway safety and pedestrian welfare.

Conclusion

In light of the significant and unresolved highway safety concerns - particularly those affecting children - I respectfully request that Sutton Council refuse this application unless a full Transport Assessment and binding mitigation strategy clearly demonstrate that there will be no detrimental effect on traffic conditions or child safety.